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forts at equality with women players treated to the same facilities— travel, stay and training—as the men. The changes are welcome, of course, but that it took this long isn't lost on Kaur.

"As women we have to constantly prove ourselves in any field and keep proving that we can do our best," she notes. For Kaur, the World Cup win is just the beginning of what she feels is an upward trajectory for not just women's cricket but women in general. Kaur adds: "Girls who don't even follow or watch the game saw the match and were inspired and elated. The victory is an incentive, it gives strength to all women. It instils the belief that we can achieve anything and bring the change. I hope we now see more women as leaders and do well in any field, anywhere."

Thankfully, for a nation which worships the sport as it does its gods, Harmanpreet and her warriors don't want to rest on that one laurel. On the radar is the upcoming T20 World Cup 2026. "I want to be part of a team that wins and sets an example and is remembered," she says. And she is happy to have that new friend camera tag along giving more spotlight to the sport. In fact, she believes that she actually manifested it: "I still remember, a few years ago, we used to discuss how people would queue up to enter the stadium to watch and cheer us one day. Now when we see it, we look at each other and smile. We all collectively dreamt of this." And she's enabled millions of girls to dream bigger.

FAVOURITE HOTEL
ITC Bengaluru. The hospitality is superb.

MOST EXPENSIVE BUY YET
A Mercedes GLS. It was a dream and I purchased it in a day.

MOST PRIZED POSSESSION
The Player of the Match trophy for my innings against England in the 2017 World Cup semi finals. I feel it brought a lot of attention and awareness to both me and Indian women's cricket.

HAS YOUR ATTITUDE TOWARD FASHION CHANGED WITH THE INCREASING SPOTLIGHT?
I have started shopping more now. I know people are watching and Kabhi bhi, koi bhi photo can go on the internet. Now, I am more aware of the fact that I have to look good.

GUILTY PLEASURE
I am not a foodie. People assume that since I am a Punjabi, I would probably like *rajma* and *kadhi* but that's not the case. *Zinda rehne ke liye, khaa liya* [I eat to stay alive]. I know that in order to train, I need to include proteins and carbs in my diet. Although, I do have the urge to eat *chhole bhature*, but I resist it.

ARE YOU A CLOTHESHORSE?
I bought a lot of blazers and suits after the World Cup. If I like something, I just buy more of the same in more colours.

IDEA OF LUXURY
A comfortable life, where you are not thinking too much and you can buy whatever you like. I have gone through a time where I would have to save money to buy something. Now I can just tap and get it.

WHO WOULD YOU HIRE AS A STYLIST IN THE DRESSING ROOM?
Mere liye toh nahi [with a laugh].